Business Management - Structural Correspondence with the 5-Stage Model

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Business Management

Structural correspondence survey with the 5-stage model (Ba / Wave / En / Uzu / Taba)

Survey Overview

- **Survey target**: 11 major theories in business management
- **Research question**: Do the various theories of business management correspond structurally to the 5-stage model?
- **Results**: Structural correspondence confirmed in all 11 cases, ranging from high alignment to partial correspondence

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Overview of the 5-Stage Model

Stage	Definition
Ba (Field)	An undifferentiated state. The initial condition in which no direction or structure has yet been established
Wave	The exploratory stage in which multiple directions diverge and compete
En (Edge)	A state of tension in which opposing elements coexist without converging on either side. The place where they meet at the boundary, influence each other, and relationships emerge
Uzu (Vortex)	The stage in which a new coherence (order) arises spontaneously from within the tension
Taba (Bundle)	The stage in which the form is fixed and stabilizes as a reusable structure

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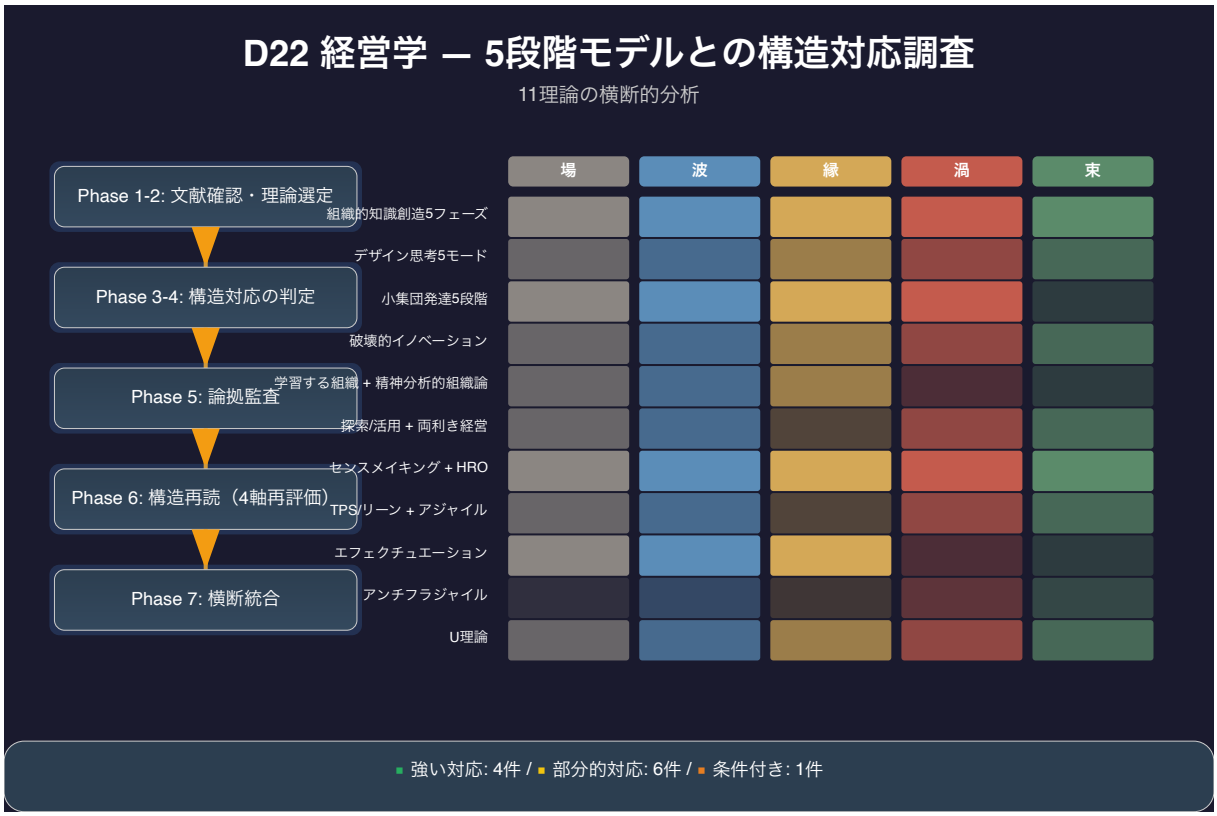

Figure 1: Domain — Research Overview Infographic

Overview of Structural Correspondences

Theory	Structural Similarity (5-stage correspondence)	Points of non-alignment	Strength of evidence
Tuckman	Forming→Storming→Norming→Performing→Adjourning highly aligns with Ba→Wave→En→Uzu→Taba	Actual teams show recursion and stagnation; linear progression is not guaranteed	High
Nonaka & Takeuchi (SECI/Ba)	The flow of tacit knowledge sharing→conceptualization→justification→prototyping→cross-leveling aligns well	The description of the driving principle (why it progresses) is weak	Medium
March (Exploration/Exploitation)	The allocation problem between exploration and exploitation is effective for explaining Uzu→Taba	The first-half transitions of Ba, Wave, En are too abstract for direct correspondence	Medium
Weick (Sensemaking)	The phase of interpretation formation aligns with Wave→En→Uzu	Does not present the full 5 stages as a stage model	Medium
Christensen (Disruptive Innovation)	New market formation is effective for explaining En→Uzu→Taba	Strong dependence on industry scale, unsuitable for comparison at team scale	Medium

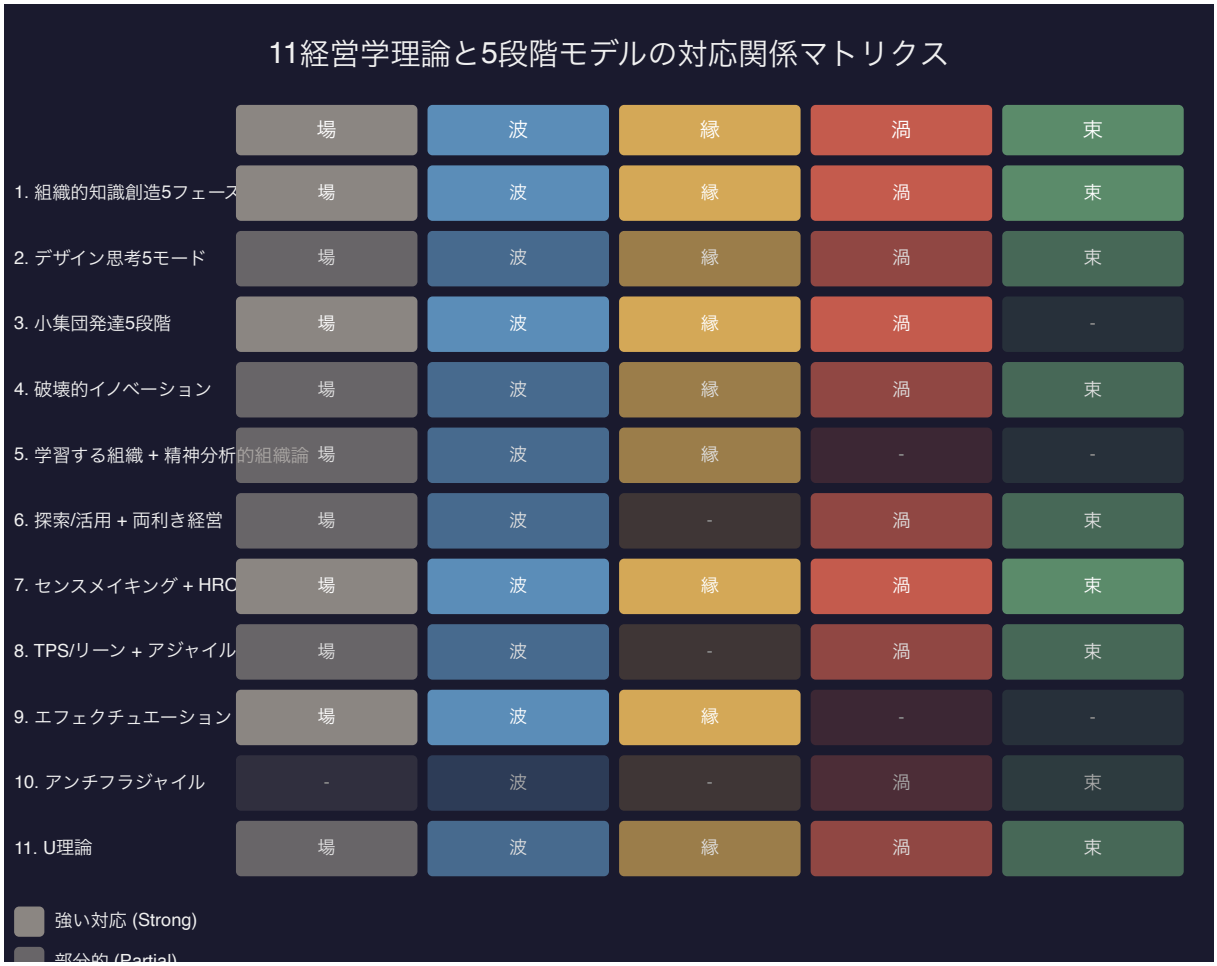

Figure 2: Domain — Theory x 5-Stage Correspondence Matrix

Key Entry 1: Tuckman Model

- **Overview**: A model describing 5 stages of team development (Forming→Storming→Norming→Performing→Adjourning)
- **Structural correspondence**: The most direct correspondence with the 5-stage model is observed. Forming corresponds to Ba, Storming to Wave, Norming to En, Performing to Uzu, and Adjourning to Taba
- **Key note**: Its limitation is that it is a linear progression model. Recursion and stagnation are frequently observed in actual teams

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Key Entry 2: Nonaka & Takeuchi's SECI Model

- **Overview**: A model describing knowledge creation as a process of conversion between tacit and explicit knowledge
- **Structural correspondence**: A flow of tacit knowledge sharing (Ba), conceptualization (Wave), justification (En), prototyping (Uzu), and cross-leveling (Taba) is confirmed
- **Key note**: The concept of "Ba (field)" resonates with the Ba of the 5-stage model, but the weak description of the driving principle is a challenge

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Key Entry 3: March's Exploration and Exploitation

- **Overview**: A theory of how organizations allocate between exploring new possibilities and exploiting existing capabilities
- **Structural correspondence**: The transition from exploration to exploitation is effective in explaining Uzu→Taba
- **Key note**: The correspondence with the earlier stages (Ba, Wave, En) is at a high level of abstraction, making direct mapping difficult

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Cross-Cutting Patterns

- The Tuckman model shows the most direct 5-stage correspondence, but has the limitation of linearity
- The validity of treating team-scale theories (Tuckman) and industry-scale theories (Christensen) on the same comparative axis requires re-examination
- Knowledge creation theory (SECI) independently holds the concept of Ba, providing rich points of contact with the 5-stage model
- Overall, correspondence with the latter stages (Uzu, Taba) tends to be clearer than with the earlier stages (Ba, Wave, En)

Unresolved Questions

- The possibility of unifying the comparative axes of team scale and industry scale
- Description of the driving principle of "why transitions occur" in each theory
- Methods for incorporating recursion and stagnation into the model
- Addition of "under what conditions does correspondence break down" in a falsifiable form for each of the 11 theories

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Conclusion

- Structural correspondence with the 5-stage model was confirmed in all 11 theories of business management

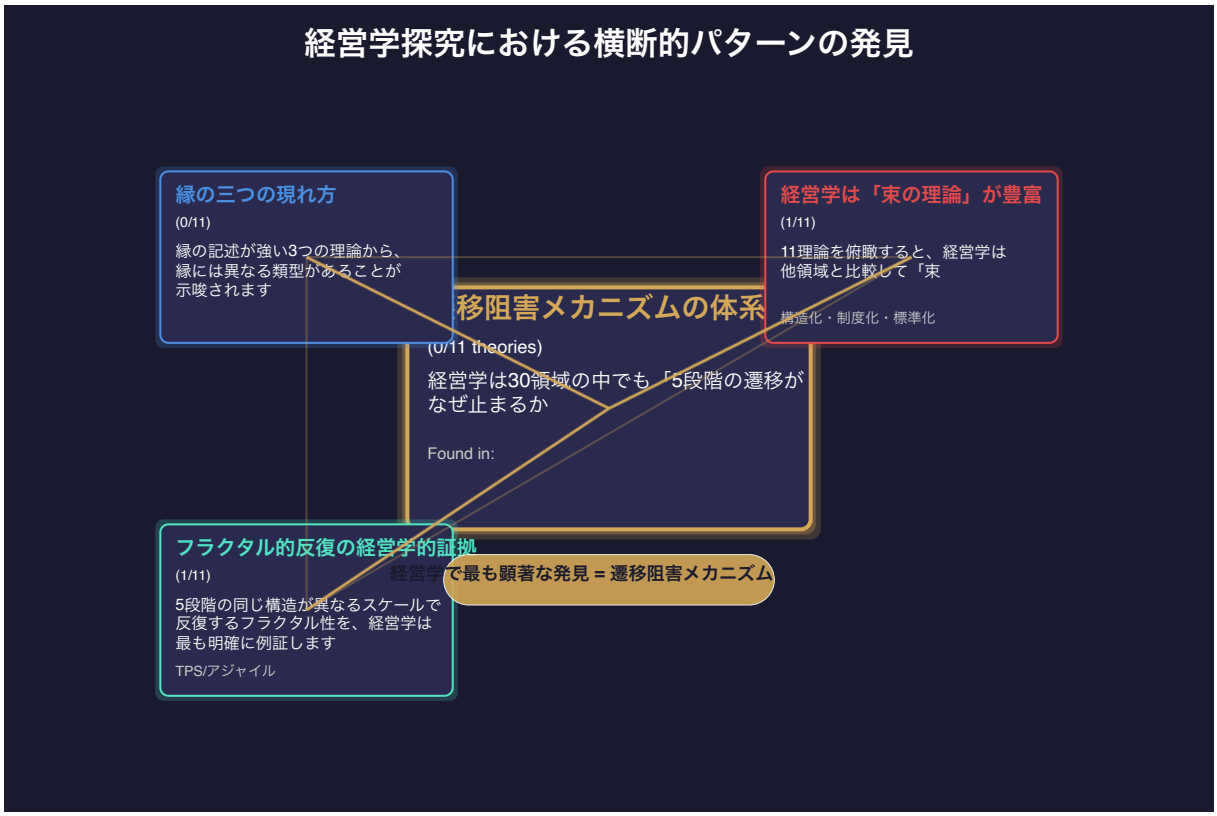

Figure 3: Domain — Cross-Cutting Patterns Diagram

- Particularly strong correspondence is seen in the Tuckman model and the Nonaka & Takeuchi SECI model
- While correspondence with the latter stages (Uzu, Taba) is generally clear, there were large differences between theories in correspondence with the earlier stages